When is there seasonal work?

	SUMMER		AUTUMN			WINTER			SPRING			SUM.
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Fruit, grapes and vegetables, month by month												
Kiwifruit · Bay of Plenty	P	P	**H**	**H**	**H**	**P**	**P**	**P**	P		P	P
Apples & pears · Hawke's Bay	T	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	T	T	**T**	**T**
Apples & pears · Nelson-Tasman	T	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	T	T	**T**	**T**
Cherries · Central Otago	**H**		H	P	P	P	P	P				**H**
Stonefruit · Central Otago	**H**	**H**	**H**		P	P	P	P				
Avocados · Northland	**H**	**H**	**H**	P	P	P	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**	**H**
Hops · Tasman			**H**	**H**			M	M	M	M	M	M
Grapes · Wairarapa	T	T	H	H	**P**	**P**	**P**	**P**	M	M	M	M
Vegetables · Horowhenua	T	H	H	H	P	H	H	H	H	H	H	H
Other work, general season												
Meat processing												
Lambing & shearing												
Dairy farms												
Forestry												
Vineyards (Marlborough & others)												
Ski fields												
Tourism, high season												
Fishing & seafood												

H harvest (picking) · **P** pruning · **T** thinning · **M** plant maintenance · outlined: busiest months. Indicative windows: seasons change with the crop, the weather, the employer and the year. In Marlborough, vineyards offer work almost all year round (PickNZ), with no official monthly calendar.

Sources: Work and Income, "Fruit and vegetable seasonal work" and "Finding seasonal work"; PickNZ. Accessed 2026-10-21. Data in datos/calendario-nz.json.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Southern Hemisphere seasons:** summer from December to February, autumn from March to May, winter from June to August and spring from September to November.
- **What this map is for:** finding your way and planning. It does not confirm jobs, wages or visa conditions: check those on immigration.govt.nz and in each job ad.
- **Dates:** parks, sectors and calendar accessed on 2026-10-21; LINZ highways, lakes and names, and the facts in the curiosity boxes, on 2026-10-22; population from the 2023 Census.

ON THE MAP

A **Tāne Mahuta, Waipoua Forest.** New Zealand's largest known living kauri tree: about 51 m tall, 13.8 m around and some 1,500 years old.

B **Waitomo Caves.** The glowworms are larvae of a fungus gnat found only in New Zealand; they glow to lure insects into sticky threads.

C **Hobbiton, near Matamata.** The Shire set from The Lord of the Rings and The Hobbit films, on a family farm. Tours run daily.

D **Arthur's Pass.** Home of the kea, the world's only alpine parrot, now nationally endangered. Clever and curious: never feed them.

E **Kawarau Bridge, near Queenstown.** The world's first commercial bungy jump (43 m), opened by AJ Hackett and Henry van Asch in 1988.

43° S
44° S
45° S
46° S
47° S
176° E
177° E
178° E
179° E